

HUJI Applicative Research Report — Healthcare — Week 39, 2026

1 high-potential paper(s) · Healthcare · Weekly · Week 39, 2026 · Generated September 21, 2026

Hebrew University researchers have unveiled a foundational understanding of how genetic variations orchestrate DNA methylation patterns across various tissues and developmental stages. This groundbreaking work establishes direct links between our genetic code and epigenetic programming, offering profound insights into gene regulation and disease susceptibility. The resulting high-resolution epigenetic atlas represents a powerful new resource. It holds significant potential for developing next-generation diagnostic tools and identifying novel therapeutic targets across a spectrum of diseases.

RESEARCHERS & RESEARCH SUBJECTS — HIGH-POTENTIAL PAPERS

- **Tommy Kaplan** — Genomics, Drug Discovery, Diagnostics, Software/AI

HEALTHCARE — RESEARCH HIGHLIGHTS

1. The genetic basis for DNA methylation variation across tissues and development.

30/50

"New atlas links genetics to epigenetics, enabling precise diagnostics and novel drug targets for disease."

Main researcher: Tommy Kaplan · tommy@cs.huji.ac.il.

School of Computer Science and Engineering, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Jerusalem, Israel. tommy@cs.huji.ac.il; Dept. of Developmental Biology and Cancer Research, Institute for Medical Research Israel-Canada, Faculty of Medicine, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Jerusalem, Israel. tommy@cs.huji.ac.il; Center for Computational Medicine, The Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Jerusalem, Israel. tommy@cs.huji.ac.il; Centre for Cancer Cell and Molecular Biology, Barts Cancer Institute, Queen Mary University of London, London, UK. tommy@cs.huji.ac.il; Centre for Epigenetics, Queen Mary University of London, London, UK. tommy@cs.huji.ac.il.

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ABOUT THIS RESEARCH

Researchers have mapped how specific genetic variations control DNA methylation patterns across different cell types and developmental stages in both mice and humans. This study identifies thousands of locations where DNA sequence changes drive epigenetic programming, linking genetics directly to gene regulation and disease risk.

COMMERCIAL ANGLE

This high-resolution atlas of sequence-dependent methylation can be leveraged to develop highly precise epigenetic biomarkers for early disease detection and to identify new regulatory targets for drug discovery.

COMMERCIALISATION METRICS

Novelty

9/10

The paper introduces a groundbreaking unifying framework that connects genetic sequence to epigenetic programming across species and developmental stages. It provides a massive, high-resolution atlas that transitions the field from descriptive epigenetics to a mechanistic understanding of how SNPs drive tissue-specific methylation.

Commercial Potential

6/10

While the atlas provides high-value foundational data for drug target discovery and disease mechanism modeling, it is a descriptive resource rather than a direct therapeutic or diagnostic product. Its commercial strength lies in its potential as a platform-enabling tool for biotech R&D rather than a standalone commercial offering.

Market Size

8/10

The atlas serves as a high-value, platform-enabling resource for drug discovery and functional genomics, potentially addressing the massive multi-billion dollar markets for precision medicine and target identification. By mapping the link between SNPs and methylation, it provides actionable data for interpreting disease-associated variants, a critical bottleneck in modern pharmaceutical R&D.

Tech Readiness

3/10

This is fundamental discovery science focused on mapping biological mechanisms and creating a descriptive atlas rather than developing a specific tool, diagnostic, or therapeutic intervention. While the data is high-value for downstream drug discovery, the research itself remains at the basic mechanistic understanding stage.

IP Strength

4/10

The paper is primarily fundamental discovery science that maps natural biological correlations rather than describing a proprietary tool, method, or molecule. While the resulting atlas is highly valuable for drug discovery, the underlying genetic and epigenetic associations themselves are natural phenomena and generally considered non-patentable.

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